

Cloud Security — Simple Plan

Print this. Find your week. Do the daily habit. That's it.

The only 3 rules

- 1. One week at a time.** Don't read ahead. Only look at the week you're on.
- 2. 25 minutes a day.** Set a timer. Phone in another room. When it rings, you may stop.
- 3. One box a day.** Tick a Day box when you finish. Five ticks = week done.

The daily habit (same every day)

- ☐ Set a 25-minute timer
- ☐ Watch / read today's material — one video or one lesson, not five
- ☐ Write 3 bullet points of what you learned
- ☐ Tick today's Day box for this week
- ☐ Close the laptop — you're done

If you feel like doing more, great — but one round is already a win.

Month 1 — Foundations

Week 1 — Threats & Principles

Learn: Malware, social engineering, CIA triad, Zero Trust

Resource: Professor Messer SY0-701 (YouTube, free)

professormesser.com/security-plus/sy0-701/



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 2 — Networking for Security

Learn: OSI, ports, firewalls, VPNs, subnetting

Resource: Cisco Networking Basics (free)

netacad.com/courses/networking-basics



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 3 — Identity & Cryptography

Learn: MFA, SSO, RBAC, hashing, PKI, TLS

Resource: Professor Messer + TryHackMe

tryhackme.com



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 4 — Fortinet FCF + Cisco Intro [CERT]

Learn: Free Fortinet FCF track + Cisco Intro to Cybersecurity

Resource: Fortinet FCF + Cisco NetAcad (both free)

training.fortinet.com

Certificate: Fortinet FCF + Cisco Intro



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Month 2 — Security+

Week 5 — Security+ Ops & IAM

Learn: Federation, SSO, incident response

Resource: Professor Messer SY0-701

professormesser.com/security-plus/sy0-701/



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 6 — Risk & Vulnerability Management

Learn: Risk math, CVSS, scanning

Resource: Qualys Training + NIST NVD (free)

qualys.com/training



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 7 — Security+ Practice Tests

Learn: Daily practice questions

Resource: ExamCompass (free)

examcompass.com



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 8 — Security+ Exam [CERT]

Learn: Final review + sit the exam

Resource: CompTIA Security+ (paid exam)

comptia.org/certifications/security

Certificate: CompTIA Security+



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Month 3 — Cloud Core

Week 9 — Cloud & AWS Core

Learn: IaaS/PaaS/SaaS, EC2, S3, IAM

Resource: AWS Cloud Quest (free)

aws.amazon.com/training/digital/aws-cloud-quest



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 10 — AWS Networking & Responsibility

Learn: VPC, Security Groups, Shared Responsibility

Resource: AWS Skill Builder (free)

skillbuilder.aws



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 11 — GCP Foundations

Learn: GCP infra, IAM, multi-cloud

Resource: Google Cloud Skills Boost

cloudskillsboost.google



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 12 — Frameworks + Badges [CERT]

Learn: Well-Architected Security Pillar

Resource: AWS Well-Architected docs

aws.amazon.com/architecture/well-architected

Certificate: AWS Cloud Quest badge



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Month 4 — App & API Security

Week 13 — Web / App Security

Learn: OWASP Top 10, XSS, CSRF

Resource: PortSwigger Web Security Academy (free)

portswigger.net/web-security



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 14 — InfoSec Projects [CERT]

Learn: Port scanner, password tool (Python)

Resource: freeCodeCamp InfoSec (free)

freecodecamp.org/learn/information-security

Certificate: freeCodeCamp InfoSec



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 15 — API Security

Learn: OWASP API Top 10, BOLA, Postman

Resource: APIsec University (free)

university.apisec.ai



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 16 — API Defense [CERT]

Learn: Rate limiting, JWT, OAuth2

Resource: APIsec University (free)

university.apisec.ai

Certificate: APIsec API Security Pro



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Month 5 — Detection & Monitoring

Week 17 — IAM & Data Protection

Learn: AssumeRole, SCPs, KMS, Secrets Manager

Resource: AWS Skill Builder Security

skillbuilder.aws



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 18 — Threat Detection

Learn: CloudTrail, GuardDuty, Config, WAF

Resource: AWS docs (free)

docs.aws.amazon.com



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 19 — SIEM Fundamentals

Learn: What a SIEM does, SPL, ingestion

Resource: Splunk Education (free)

splunk.com/en_us/training/free-courses



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 20 — Log Analysis [CERT]

Learn: Search, alerts, dashboards

Resource: TryHackMe SOC Level 1

tryhackme.com/path/outline/soclevel1

Certificate: Splunk Intro + AWS Security badge



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Month 6 — Build & Get Hired

Week 21 — Terraform & IaC Security

Learn: HCL, Checkov, Trivy

Resource: HashiCorp Developer (free)

developer.hashicorp.com/terraform/tutorials



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 22 — Capstone Build [CERT]

Learn: Secure VPC / ALB / WAF / CloudTrail via Terraform

Resource: Your AWS + GitHub

github.com

Certificate: HashiCorp Terraform badge



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 23 — Document & Profile

Learn: README, blog post, resume, LinkedIn

Resource: draw.io + Medium

app.diagrams.net



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 24 — Interview & Apply [CERT]

Learn: STAR answers + technical Qs + apply to jobs

Resource: r/cloudsecurity

reddit.com/r/cloudsecurity

Certificate: Capstone published



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Month 7 — AI Security

Week 25 — AI Threat Landscape

Learn: OWASP LLM Top 10 — prompt injection, data leakage, model poisoning

Resource: OWASP LLM Top 10 + MITRE ATLAS (free)

owasp.org/www-project-top-10-for-large-language-model-applications



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 26 — AI Governance & Compliance

Learn: NIST AI RMF, EU AI Act basics

Resource: NIST AI RMF + EU AI Act (free)

nist.gov/itl/ai-risk-management-framework



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 27 — Hands-on AI Attack Labs

Learn: Prompt injection practice, adversarial ML basics

Resource: Gandalf by Lakera (free lab)

gandalf.lakera.ai



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

Week 28 — AI Security Capstone Addition [CERT]

Learn: Add secured LLM API endpoint + IAM scope to capstone

Resource: Your GitHub + AWS + Lakera blog

github.com

Certificate: OWASP LLM Top 10 completion



Day 1



Day 2



Day 3



Day 4



Day 5

When you miss a day (you will — that's fine)

Missing one day is normal. The only rule: **never miss two in a row**. Don't restart the plan, don't feel guilty, don't try to make up hours. Just do today's 25 minutes. That is the whole recovery.

Start here, today

Go to **Week 1**. Set a 25-minute timer. Press play on the first Professor Messer video.

That is the only thing that matters today.